

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

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cont. Yet dear Br. we are urged to pray for the triumph of the Church as though her triumph depended on our prayers. So it does in a manner depend on our prayers - to a very great extent. Almighty God has so provided, has placed it in our hands to effect the triumph of the Church or leave it to others. My Dear Br. it is easy to know that the Church will triumph. My Dear Br. it is easy to know that God has kept His promises to His Church. It is easy to know that Jesus has been always with her. It is easy to know that she has triumphed over error of every form and color for 1900 years. If St. Augustin could point to the Church of his time as a standing miracle of the fifth century, how much more may we not point to her today as the miracle of the twentieth century?

Pg. 40 On This Rock I will build my Ch. & -- not prevail against it. "There is nothing new under the sun," the inspired writer tells us. Yet nothing is permanent - all is change. The flowers of the field bloom and fade. The bubbles of the swelling tide are seen and brake. The gushes of the mountain torrent rush on to the ocean never again to return. Men and nations too have their seasons and pass away. Promises are forgotten; treaties disregarded. There is one thing, however, that does not change, "the Word of the Lord remaineth forever" and His promises are eternally infallible - eternally unfailing in fulfillment. For, "God is not like man that He should lie, nor as the sons of men that He should deceive." Has He said then and will He not do? Has He promised and will He not fulfill?" Why then should it be necessary to pray for God's Church? When Jesus assures us that the gates of Hell shall not prevail," shall we be intimidated by Satan? Is God's assurance not enough for us? Do we not know for sure that the Church must triumph? "On this rock I will build my Church and the gates of Hell shall not -- it." I will send you another paraclete who will remain with you forever "Behold I am with you all days even to the consummation of the world." Why then be anxious about the triumph